

1.2 Conventions of comics

Conventions of comic design and layout

- Colour
- Typography
- Text styling for narration and captions
- Text styling for onomatopoeia
- Text styling for communication
- Focal points within panels
- Environment/backgrounds

Conventions for story telling within comics

- Comic panel shape/size
- Comic panel layout
 - splash page
 - spread
 - rule of thirds
 - panel staggering
 - panel sequencing
 - western style
 - manga style
- Comic panel story flow
- Communication bubbles
 - shape
 - sequence
 - placement
- Narration/captions
 - style of caption and narration boxes
 - positioning of boxes
 - text style used in narration/caption boxes
- Onomatopoeia use

Creativity in characters and comics

- Originality
- Imaginative design
- Derivative design

To include:

- Using colour to depict genre or comic theme e.g. horror, sci-fi, romance, thriller/action, comedy, children's comic
- The typography and text styles used in comics
- Using focal points within each panel to draw the reader's eye to key points and support the story flow
- Using environments and backgrounds to set the scene
- How assets and components are used to create content within comics

To include:

- Using panel layout to convey the story flow/speed of action/content/passage of time
- Using communication bubbles to convey expression/emotion and indicate the order communication should be read
- Using narration/captions to convey meaning and tell the story
- Using onomatopoeia for emphasis/exaggerated reaction

To include:

- How original work differs from adaptations to existing designs
- How imaginative work can be derivative
- How to balance following conventions with originality/imagination to produce creative products

Unit R095: Characters and comics